

Social Media

THE RISE OF INFLUENCE



Social media is not just influencing careers, it's redefining how success is perceived.

Social media has become a major part of everyday life, especially for young adults who rely on platforms like TikTok and YouTube for information and inspiration. It provides access to a large amount of research and information that is easily accessible while you scroll when you're bored.

Many people turn to platforms like TikTok or YouTube to quickly search for information they don't understand, often relying on real people to explain topics in a simple and engaging way.



THE RISE OF SOCIAL MEDIA INFLUENCE

Social media is increasingly shaping what people want to do for a living, as it exposes individuals to diverse career paths, industry trends, and professional communities. There are thousands, if not millions of videos on different platforms like YouTube, TikTok, Instagram, and Facebook, of people showing off their lavish lifestyles, and a bunch of expensive cars, luxury apartments, and nice houses, while explaining their careers and how they achieved financial success.



CAREER VALUES & PRIORITIES

This has been a major factor in the influence of the younger generation's career choices, as it has become more common for individuals to prioritize salary and financial stability. Through these platforms, like LinkedIn, Indeed, ZipRecruiter and Handshake as well, students are able to gain insight into different careers and learn about the skills required to succeed.

THE RISKS BEHIND SOCIAL MEDIA

However, while social media provides valuable information, it may also present misleading or unrealistic portrayals of careers, some individuals reuse content they do not own or falsely represent how they earn income, which can mislead viewers. This is very common with fraudsters and has contributed to an increase in "get rich quick" scams targeted toward younger people. The cryptocurrency community, has earned a reputation for having a higher presence of fraudsters and misleading financial claims.



HOW SOCIAL MEDIA SHAPES CAREERS

FROM SCROLLING TO SUCCESS



WHAT RESEARCH SHOWS

Research by Li et al. (2025) shows that social media influences career decisions by shaping how students view job opportunities, workplace expectations, and long-term goals. This suggests that social media is not only informing students about careers but actively shaping their expectations and definitions of success. This can ultimately influence how individuals evaluate potential jobs, often focusing more on perceived rewards, rather than job satisfaction, as students are consistently exposed to various content highlighting different career paths.

SHAPING CAREER MINDSETS

There are also other professional & academic communities that span across various websites or applications. The research also found that social media helps and encourages students to shape their work values like salary, stability, and a personal and work life balance. For many college students, social media is not just entertainment, but a key influence on how they view future careers.

ONLINE COMMUNITIES & INFLUENCE

Large groups of students, along with regular individuals, will come together and create communities where they share knowledge and insight. A great example of one of these communities is the trading community. There are multiple groups and teams of people who are focused on making trades and staying within market trends; a lot of these will have chat servers and post alerts to let other traders know about a trade with potential value.

